

completely out of touch with her finances, and clever Carrie Bradshaw in *Sex and the City* was still somehow not clever enough to afford a down payment on an apartment.

Why?

Due to buying too many shoes.

I watched *Confessions of a Shopaholic* as a child and vividly remember the scene where Rebecca, the protagonist, is so moved by a green scarf she sees in a shop window that she must have it, despite being debt-ridden. ‘You just got a credit card bill of \$900 — you do not need a scarf,’ Rebecca tells herself, but ultimately ends up splitting the payment across four different credit cards. I received the message that that was how I was meant to act.

The messaging didn’t change as I grew older; in *The Wolf of Wall Street*, the two largest female roles in the ‘financial movie of the decade’ show that women either think money is evil and want no part of it like Jordan Belfort’s first wife, Denise Lombardo, or are gold diggers who would leave a man if he lost his wealth like his second wife, Nadine Caridi. There is no in between. The only notable female trader in the office depicted in the movie agrees to have her head shaved in front of the trading floor for \$10 000 so she can use the money to get D-cup breast implants. Let me make it very clear that cosmetic surgery itself is not the issue. But through the male gaze the movie depicted this woman, the one representative for women on the trading floor, as nothing but a frivolous spender. In reality, a female broker winning \$10 000 would have likely considered investing the money.

Money media speak to men about growing their wealth and portray it as a masculine trait. Articles directed at men talk about investing strategies or encourage debates about the latest cryptocurrency, while articles directed at women tell us about a new hack to save \$10 a week on groceries. And it’s not just anecdotal: a 2018 analysis by Starling Bank in the UK scanned over 300 finance articles and showed 70 per cent of money media directed at men discussed investing, while 65 per cent of money media directed at women were about spending less. Women are told financial planning is complex, threatening and ‘a minefield’. Men, on the other hand, are encouraged to speak about portfolios and take on risk, and themes of strength and power dominate. This encouragement of men to take on more